

PURPOSE: For ‘pajama jeans’ to be permitted on the 1st floor of each residence hall and after the academic school day.

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BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE

SECTION ONE (DEFINITIONS):

Pajama jeans: -Easy to wear- Pull-up jeans for women or men that have a relaxed, pajama-like feel, so you get a stylish fit without the tugging, stretching, and sucking in of traditional denim.
MAY SOMETIMES INSINUATE PAJAMA PANTS

Pajama pants: loose lightweight trousers

SECTION TWO (REASONING):

Although it can seem unprofessional to guests visiting MSMS to see students wearing ‘pajama jeans’ to class during the academic school day, students should be allowed to be comfortable in their own residence halls and after school. While comfort might not be the priority during the school day, it should be inside of the residence halls, including the first-floor lobby. When trekking down the staircase to meet a friend in the lobby or printing a chemistry lab dangerously close to the time of room check, It is very inconvenient to have to change out of my pajama jeans into more formal attire. There is no specific reason as to why pajama jeans are not permitted inside the lobbies and on the first floor. If the pajama jeans themselves follow the same modesty requirements as every other pair of pants and shorts in the handbook, it should not prove a problem specifically on the first floor.

The same logic can be applied after the academic school day. While grabbing dinner or studying in the library, I as an MSMS student should have the same right to wear pajama jeans as other MUW students. It is not distracting in the learning environment, for classes are not being held. It is also not labeled as ‘unprofessional’ because there is usually no one around who is forming negative opinions of MSMS students because of their pajama jean attire. Lots of students already wear pajama jeans unnoticed, but with its exclusion in the handbook, this opens up inconsistent dress code infractions for students: some getting caught in their pajama jeans and others slipping right by.

SECTION THREE (SPECIFIC CHANGE):

On Pages 29 and 30 of the Student Handbook (PDF pages 34 and 35), the following will be changed,

DRESS AND GROOMING

Dress and grooming standards are established to ensure that the school climate reflects safety, appropriateness, and a serious focus on learning. We recognize that fashions, styles, and trends evolve; therefore, the school reserves authority in matters which may arise and are not identified within this policy. MSMS staff reserves the right to request students to return to their residence hall to change if attire is deemed inappropriate or potentially disruptive to the educational process. Both Residential Life and Academic Affairs shall enforce this policy. The final authority regarding proper dress and grooming shall be the MSMS Administration.

The following standards must be followed AT ALL TIMES:

- 1) Appropriate undergarments must be worn and should not be visible; and students should not go shirtless;
- 2) Footwear must be worn when outside the residence hall room;
- 3) Clothing may not contain slogans or images which are considered profane or vulgar; or promote tobacco products, alcohol, drugs, or gang affiliation; or are considered insensitive to race, religion, sexual orientation, ethnicity or gender;
- 4) Leggings that are see-through or have mesh inserts, clothing considered sleepwear/loungewear ~~and pajama jeans~~ may not be worn outside the residence halls or in the 1st-floor lobby of the residence halls;
- 5) Clothing must provide adequate covering:
 - a. Skirts, dresses, shorts, or similar attire must be finger-tip length while standing and must allow for stooping, bending, and sitting modestly. The appropriate length must be evident in the front and back;
 - b. Muscle shirts, mesh/transparent tops, or low-cut tops are not permitted;
 - c. Shirts should be long enough that, at all times, they meet the top of the pants or skirt or shorts so that the midriff, lower back, and/or underwear are not exposed;
 - d. Halters, strapless attire (including off-the shoulder), and spaghetti straps are prohibited; Clothing may not have holes, cuts, slits, rips, or tears that expose or nearly expose underwear or skin above fingertip length.
- 6) Waistbands must be worn at the waist (no sagging pants);

Clothing, wigs, face paint and other items of attire that could be classified as “costumes” are not appropriate for general school wear, unless being worn during a school-approved day and/or activity. The other dress code guidelines shall still be followed.